Chinese Emperor will please to appoint, and to endeavour to bring the matter to a peaceable conclusion, by consigning the conventions they would do between them to a document.

This was made on the 5th of 8th month, on the next day or 6th the ambassador Okubo has put to sea, and embarking on board the "Riojokan" at Nagasaki thence directly proceeded for Peking. Thus, he is now on the point of settling the question by the negotiation with the commissioner of Peking government, according to the Imperial Instruction.

Translation

When on his way to Peking, the Minister Yanagihara stopped at Tsien tien, he had an interview with Li-hung-chang, the viceroy of Pechi-li on the 24th of the seventh month, when the latter made a question, the chief import of which is a follows: (No 2)

"The present expedition of your country to the aboriginal Formosa originated in your contempt for our weakness and was an occasion of our dishonor towards the nations of the world. The aboriginal part of Formosa being subject to us, we have evidently the right to punish the offenders who committed the barbarous actions towards the shipwrecked persons, if your government should have only desired

this

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"this to us. But, your government
"suddenly dispatched an army to
"punish them. This action of your
"government is just like what is
"said in the book of Usun-Tsun
"wrongly to invade and attack ano-
"her's territory, we desire consequently
"the speedy evacuation of Formosa by
"the general Saigo's troops.

The attitude of Li-hung-chang
was very presumtuous and his man-
ner of utterance was quite insolent.
He intended evidently, by
this to restrain the Minister Ya-
maghiwara from going to Peking.
However, the Minister Ya-
maghiwara, in accordance with the
imperial order, answered him as
follows:

"The aboriginal portion of For-
"mosa has been, long since, in-

"dependent. When England and
"America sent each an expedition-
"ary corps to it, to inflict the puni-
"shment, your government paid no
"attention to their actions. Moreover,
"We hear from our army now in For-
"mosa, that the aboriginal savages have
"always entertained the hostile feelings
"towards China, even amusing them-
"selves by the murder of your country-
"men, still your government inflict-
"ed no punishment upon them; this
"is a clear evidence of their territorys
"not lying within your jurisdiction.
"Now, let us suppose that there
"lies a territory of wild savages, bet-
"ween two countries, Who always com-
"mit the harms upon the neighbours
"and take pleasure in murdering
"the people. If then, one of the two
"countries do not punish them, the

other

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other should be justified in taking
their punishment into her own hand.
This is based on the universal law
of nations. There is thus no reason
to call our action an unjust in-
vasion and attack of another's territory.
upon this, Yanaghiwara following
the Imperial order and thinking that
Yeiendin was not the proper place
to hold discussion, he did not ac-
cept Li-hung-chang's proposals
and arrived at Peking on the 31.
of the seventh month.

On the 3rd of the eighth month
Yanaghiwara received three dispatches
one of which was addressed him by
Young-li-yamen and other two
were from Shin and Pan. The
chief meaning of the Young-li-ya-
men's dispatch is to persevere in
the purpose mentioned in two for-

mer dispatches and it contains
several insolent words, designating
the sojourn of the minister, as a
means to beguile the Chinese govern-
ment by fair words and especially
as it says, that the reply of the
Minister to show the agreement of the
present expedition with the proposal
of the last year is not only to dis-
avow himself but to deceive the high
members of the Young-li-yamen.
As to the two dispatches from Shin
and Pan, they contain no word to
excuse themselves from the contradiction
and besides added to the in-consis-
tency with the former promise as
they contain the pretension, that the
first and second articles were alrea-
dy settled and the desire, that the
measures of the third article for
bringing about the future friendship

being

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being their (Shin and Pan's) proper province, the Japanese troops should soon evacuate Formosa. The actions of Shin and Pan are evidently to deceive both Yanaghiwara and Saigo, taking advantage of the distance of their place of sojourn and we can designate them as being deceitful and odious.

Afterwards, Yanaghiwara sent the reply to Tsung-li-Yamen's dispatch, to show that the aboriginals of Formosa have been always independent tribes, the Chinese government disclaiming them as lying beyond the jurisdiction of China and that they cannot be considered as ranking among the nations of the world as they made pillage and murder their professions and they have no established government

nor laws.

On the 7th of the eighth month, the Minister Yanaghiwara visited Tsung-li-Yamen and had an interview with seven high officials including Pao, When they made the following propositions in the principal points:

"The aboriginal Formosa belongs to China. Now, the action of your government in dispatching an army there, without informing before hand of it, is a wrong done to the Chinese sovereignty and contravenes the law of nations. This is, we repeat, an unreasonable action, interfering in the internal affairs of China.

"The aboriginal territory, though not being under the jurisdiction of China, lies contiguous to our district of Taiwanfoo, and the relation of China to this territory in regard

to

to the nearness of distance is unlike to that of your country, which lies far beyond the Wide Ocean. From this, we conclude that this territory belongs to China, etc. etc."

On this, Yanaghiwara arguing upon the reason and principles answered thus:

"The aboriginal territory lies beyond the jurisdiction of China; if so, it must be independent and without any ruler. How, this independent savages murdered our people, for which we have taken the rightful measures to punish them. Our communication of the last year was only owing to the good will conceived towards you. Shall it be rightful to invent some pretensions at present, while you did not make any objection then?

Although you pretend from your ignorance of the actual state of the aboriginal territory, that the action of Japan is to invade the territory belonging to China, there is no evidence of your jurisdictions ever having extended to this territory. On the contrary, there is a clear evidence, both by the ancient and modern books and by the confirmation of the officers now being there, that this territory has never been under the Chinese jurisdiction. Besides, the conquest of your portion of Formosa dates back only to the years of Kang-hi, and the boundary-line has been marked out between your portion and that of the aboriginals. Even more, the savages take the pleasure in murdering your people and they are

are very proud of the number of their skulls, taking this as the standard for comparing the prowess in war. But your government never paid any attention to such an outrage. Now, in punishing these wild and independent savages, We have in no wise interfered in the internal affairs of your country. Our only intention is to hold up the right of an independent nation and to fulfill the duty towards our people. Our title is rightful and our language is honest. I believe thus that your Excellencies will believe my words, if you will take the matter into serious considerations."

On this, all the Chinese officials were silent, and then they promised to visit Yanaghiwara

within a few days; the negotiation ending thus, Yanaghiwara returned to his lodging.

On the 10th of the eigh month, Yanaghiwara again sent a dispatch to Shin and Pan, inquiring them why they have not fulfilled their promise and pointing them out, that their opinion making the Penangs free from guilt, is founded only on the knowledge of the assistance offered by Ding-an-tsung, while they knew nothing about the pillage of the clothes and the valuables by the savages.

On the 19th of the eighth month, His Excellency Okubo, the ambassador plenipotentiary, arrived at Shanghai amidst the most pressing preparations of war by the Chinese.

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